same for any dad. So in the days after, it was a case of trying to workout what we could do. I lost count of the number of experts that we took advice from. Some of the time, it felt like we were just getting more and more confused: everybody had different ideas and I even had the feeling that a certain amount of politics was behind some of it, people staking claims for their own reputations at the same time as offering to help. It came down to not being sure exactly who we could trust.

In the end, the person we turned to was Tony, Victoria's dad. He'd always taken an interest in security equipment in connection with his own work and, when we bought the house in Sawbridgeworth, he'd put in alarm systems without us, until now, ever having to know the details. These security measures were sophisticated enough to impress the officers from Scotland Yard when they began looking at what improvements they thought we could make to our arrangements.

We've now got levels of security in our lives, from day to day, which we'd not even considered before the kidnap plot was uncovered. It's not easy: never mind going to work or out to social engagements, we've always wanted to be able to go down to Marks & Spencer or McDonald's like any other family. Now we have to be careful like never before. At the same time as making sure the boys are safe, we've tried not to make life too strange for them. In the day or two just after the plot was uncovered, I told Brooklyn that the policeman parked outside had come down especially to show him his car. You can imagine what a three-year-old made of that: he was out there every ten minutes wanting to sit behind the wheel and turn the patrol car's lights on and off.

If you'd asked me then, I'd have said that I'd rather not play against Leicester in the Worthington Cup on the Tuesday night after that Saturday afternoon. The manager had said he was going to rest those players who he thought needed a break. And I felt like I was one of those players. Over the years, we've sometimes not played our strongest side in that competition. It's been an opportunity for younger players to come in and make their mark, like I did, down at Brighton, nearly ten years ago. But my name was on the teamsheet against Leicester; and, if I was picked to play for United, the boss knew he'd get no argument from me.

There's always a very good reason behind every decision the manager makes. You may not agree with it at the time—like when he'd left me out against Leeds—but, when you stop and think, you remember that all he's focused on is what's right for the team. And often that turns out to be the right